

February - March 2025 Analysis

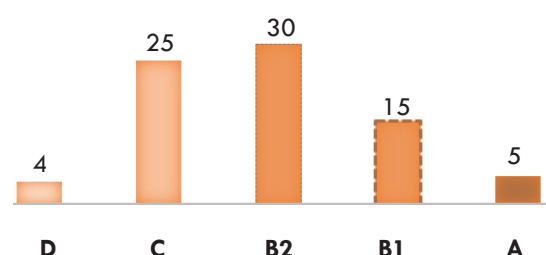
The NAWG meeting was held on April 2nd, 2025 to discuss the analysis from the **February to March** period.

The NAF encompasses data from a variety of sources (including **FSNMS, ISNA, IPC AFI and AMN, SMART surveys, JMMI, ACLED, IRNAs, REACH data, IOM DTM, WHO IDSR, PRMS, data from Clusters**) which inform the following indicators:

- **Identifying vulnerability**
 - Proportion of female-headed households, child-headed households and other vulnerable-group headed households
 - Proportion of IDPs and/or returnees compared to host communities
 - Longitudinal food insecurity
- **Protection**
 - Reports of explosive hazards, lack of access to humanitarian assistance, restriction of movement, sexual violence, family separation, HLP issues, child labour, civil documentation issues, among others
 - Armed conflict events and/or conflict-related sexual violence and/or forced recruitment of children and/or targeted killings of civilians and/or targeted property destruction
- **Displacement**
 - Number of displaced persons arriving and/or number of returnees returning, as significant numbers of arrivals has the potential to exacerbate food and resource access
- **Disease**
 - Disease outbreaks, including cholera, measles, meningitis, and malaria, among others
- **Food insecurity**
 - IPC AFI classifications are used for each county
- **Malnutrition**
 - IPC AMN classifications or SMART survey data are used to estimate crude mortality



Number of counties within each severity band for the February to March 2025 analysis period



For more information on the Needs Analysis Working Group or the NAWG Analytical Framework, please contact Felix Omuu (omuu@un.org) or Rebecca Hetzer (rebecca.hetzer@impact-initiatives.org).

Needs severity levels

Severity band	Indicator threshold	Severity level definitions
A	8 - 10	Extreme humanitarian conditions
B1	7 - 7.9	Severe humanitarian conditions (higher severity)
B2	6 - 6.9	Severe humanitarian conditions (lower severity)
C	4 - 5.9	Moderate humanitarian conditions
D	2 - 3.9	Stressed humanitarian conditions
E	0 - 1.9	Minor or acceptable humanitarian conditions

SOUTH SUDAN - NEEDS ANALYSIS WORKING GROUP (NAWG)

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Counties facing “extreme” humanitarian conditions

Based on the backend analysis, three counties were initially classified as ‘Band A’, namely: **Pibor, Renk, and Nasir**.

Following in-depth discussion and contextual analysis during the NAWG meeting, **Fangak** and **Ulang** were ultimately classified as exhibiting extreme humanitarian needs (Band A).

Discussion and joint analysis

- **Fangak:** A recent REACH public health assessment revealed alarming signs consistent with IPC Phase 5 acute food insecurity in Old Fangak, especially among vulnerable returnees from Sudan who are resorting to universal emergency coping strategies. The county continues to battle a severe cholera outbreak and remains heavily impacted by recurrent, devastating floods since 2019. Fangak has recently received new influxes of IDPs displaced by clashes in neighboring Panyikang County. Following discussion, Fangak was elevated to the highest severity classification due to multiple compounding crises. **Final classification: Elevated from Band B1 to Band A.**
- **Ulang:** Recent assessments confirm displacement affecting tens of thousands of people fleeing conflict. This is compounded by significant health risks from cholera and malaria outbreaks. Critically, humanitarian partners have scaled back operations due to funding cuts and security concerns, reportedly leaving the vast majority of nutrition sites in Ulang (20 out of 21) without adequate supplies. In early April, partners are unable to deliver food assistance – a key mitigating factor in the IPC analysis – to these areas which are projected to face IPC Phase 4 conditions between April and July, primarily due to access restrictions linked to ongoing conflict. **Final classification: Elevated from Band B1 to Band A.**
- **Nyiröl:** Flagged for discussion due to a severe and ongoing cholera outbreak, with high reported case fatality rates. Access limitations, particularly within Chuil Payam, hinder effective response efforts and information gathering. Reports also suggest an influx of IDPs arriving from conflict-affected areas in Upper Nile, notably Nasir, although these movements require further verification by partners. **Final classification: Remains at Band B1.**
- **Malakal:** Discussion centered on the anticipated deterioration into IPC Phase 5 (Catastrophe) conditions for 10,000 people starting in April 2025, according to two recent SMART surveys, alongside concerns that the county has not adequately recovered from previous major flooding events. Recent conflict in Upper Nile State has triggered complex displacement dynamics,

with IDPs arriving in Malakal seeking safety, while others, including specific ethnic groups, are reportedly leaving due to a heavy military presence. This constant flux makes population figures and needs projections difficult. The severity of the previous lean season, noted as the worst on record, underscores the underlying vulnerability. **Final classification remains at Band B1, and added to close monitoring.**

- **Panyikang:** Flagged due to fighting reported at the end of March, with Tonga town of particular concern, including the possibility of renewed clashes in the coming weeks. Movement restrictions are hampering access and civilian mobility. Displacement towards Jonglei State and north into Sudan is a concern. Members highlighted the risk of violence spilling into neighboring areas along the Tonga-Atar corridor and noted that displaced populations remain largely inaccessible to humanitarian aid. **Final classification: Remains at Band B2, and added to close monitoring.**
- **Longochuk:** Flagged following a reported airstrike in Mathiang Village in March which reportedly resulted in civilian casualties (one death, eight injuries), property destruction, and widespread panic. This incident, along with broader regional tensions, reportedly triggered new population movements towards Ethiopia. Additionally, some civilians fleeing conflict in nearby Tonga were reportedly intercepted and forced back by opposition forces, leading many to abandon Tonga town due to perceived threats. **Final classification: Remains at Band B2, and added to close monitoring.**
- **Nagero:** Flagged due to the ongoing impact of conflict spillover from neighboring Tambura County, compounded by a direct military confrontation within Nagero itself in January 2025. An IRNA conducted in early March confirmed significant humanitarian needs among the displaced population, many of whom have since reportedly moved towards Wau seeking assistance. Despite IRNA recommendations for immediate food distribution, partners indicated no imminent plans. Concerns were voiced regarding the lack of partner presence in the county. It was noted that light responses were provided to some IDPs in Nagero and Morobo counties during the IRNA. However, there is a need to follow up on the situation since the IRNA was conducted. **Final classification: Elevated from Band C to Band B2, and added to close monitoring.**

Counties Flagged for Close Monitoring

The following counties have been flagged for close monitoring to encourage partners to gather more information and closely track the evolving situation. **Partners are requested to pay close attention to these counties and share any relevant information.**

- **Pibor:** Despite already being classified at the highest severity level, Pibor requires continued intense monitoring due to a deadly cholera outbreak exhibiting a very high

case fatality rate, coupled with extremely limited healthcare access. IPC analysis projects pockets of IPC Phase 5 (Catastrophe) food insecurity beginning in April. Response efforts are severely hampered by shortages of essential supplies and the reported suspension of 17 SSHF-funded projects in Pibor and Nasir, impacting around 46,000 people. Recent attacks in Gumuruk were also raised, with reports of 13,000 people displaced. **Final classification: Band A.**

- **Nasir:** Nasir also remains at the highest severity level and requires close monitoring due to the devastating combination of a cholera outbreak and active conflict. Reports from displacement sites near the Ethiopian border indicate severe public health risks, including open defecation and reliance on untreated water. Access for humanitarian actors is severely restricted by military activities, hindering assessments and aid delivery, with concerning anecdotal reports of damage to humanitarian facilities and potential casualties among aid workers. Large-scale displacement into Ethiopia continues, posing significant protection risks. Crucially, partners noted an inability to deliver food assistance, a factor identified by the IPC as essential to prevent catastrophic outcomes. **Final classification: Band A.**
- **Akobo:** Flagged for close monitoring due to the reported cholera outbreak, compounded by the security concerns following an airstrike reported in March 2025. **Final classification: Band B1.**
- **Magwi:** Requires close monitoring following recent, albeit reportedly localized, clashes between government and opposition forces. While the overall situation is described as calm and most IDPs from previous incidents have returned home, the underlying potential for renewed instability warrants continued observation. **Final classification: Band C.**
- **Morobo:** Flagged for close monitoring after an attack in late March led to new displacement towards Uganda. **Final classification: Band C.**
- **Yei:** Flagged for close monitoring due to its proximity to areas experiencing instability (like Morobo) and the potential for spillover effects from regional conflict dynamics, which could impact security and humanitarian conditions within the county. **Final classification: Band C.**
- **Yambio:** Flagged for close monitoring due to persistent political tensions following the removal of the state governor. Reports of the mobilisation of armed forces could contribute to an environment of uncertainty that could potentially impact stability and humanitarian access. **Final classification: Band D.**